

Fall 2025
Somatic Symptom and Related
Disorders (Previously Somatoform Disorders)
Including in part: Somatic Symptom Disorder, Conversion Disorder, and
Factitious Disorder/Factitious Disorder by Proxy, and
Malingering

Lecture Objectives

At the end of this 4-hour lecture, students will have a better understanding of the following:

I. Somatic Symptom and Related Disorders

1. Understand DSM -5-TR criteria of a Somatic Symptom Disorder (SSD)
2. Better understand the course of this illness, medical illnesses to rule out as well as treatment.
3. Recognize Potential Symptoms of SSD, including: GI, GU, Pain, neuropsychiatric, etc.
4. Treatment employing "CARE MD"
5. Be able define Illness Anxiety Disorder (DSM-5-TR) (~Hypochondriasis in DSM-4), as well as prognosis, treatment etc.
6. Understand what is a Functional Neurological Symptom Disorder (FNSD) (Conversion Disorder), including symptoms, criteria and specific terms, including: la belle indifference, pseudo-hallucinations, primary vs. secondary gain, stocking glove anesthesia etc.
7. Become aware of differential diagnosis of FNSD
8. Be able to recognize the Psychological Factors Affecting Other Medical Conditions (DSM-5-TR)
9. Other Specified Somatic Symptom and Related Disorder (DSM -5-TR)
 - a. Understand pseudocyesis and other psychiatric diagnoses under this heading

II. Factitious Disorder Imposed on Self and Factitious Disorder Imposed on Another (by Proxy)

1. Understand the Basic DSM-5-TR criteria for Factitious disorder
2. Understand the history
3. Understand terminology such as:
 - a. Peregrination
 - b. Pseudologica fantastica
 - c. Hospital hobos and addicts
4. Understand when to consider the diagnosis of Factitious disorder, and how to
 - a. Recognize warning signs, symptoms, etiology and methods used to impose injury on oneself, and treatment of this disorder

5. Understand criteria for Factitious Disorder Imposed on Another.
6. Understand how one can detect Factitious Disorder Imposed on Another (FDIOA).
7. Recognize the warning signs of this illness?
8. Understand possible relationship of crib death and FDIOA

III. Malingering

1. Understand whether it is an accepted DSM -5-TR diagnosis
2. Understand the definition of malingering?
3. Recognize the warning signs of malingering
4. Understand how to differentiate malingering from somatic system disorder and factitious disorder by assessing motivation and illness production